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The Silk In The Web

As online businesses increasingly realise the importance of their Web sites' functionality, the Web programmer flourishes

Samir Makwana

The face of the Web has changed over the past few years. If you remember what most Web pages were like a few years ago, you'll vouch for that. They're getting more complex, they're prettier, and they're more functional, too. Of course, we're generalising, but take just one example: what was Amazon.com like some years ago, and what is it today? In case you're too young to remember, trust us, it was very different—and limited in comparison, in terms of just what we've mentioned: complexity, prettiness, functionality, and more.

Many new Web sites offer online services like word processing, spreadsheets, and image editing, which we normally do on our Desktops. In fact, that is one of the elements that go into the making of what we call Web

2.0—Web sites offering applications that have the functionality of Desktop applications.

The Web programmer is playing an increasingly sophisticated role.

Hard Code

Web programming is different from Web designing. The latter focuses on the look and feel of the site, while Web programming has to do with the functioning of the Web site as a whole. But somewhere or the other, the work of the Web designer does overlap with that of the Web programmer: they may use the same product for creating a page, or similarly edit the code to impart a better look and feel to a page.

A Snapshot Of The Field

Programming for Web sites involves both Web authoring software such as Adobe Dreamweaver, and programming languages such as C, C++, Visual C++, etc. Code for Web sites is written for performing specific functions such as searches, access to databases, and any processing of text, graphics, animation, and other audio-visual content for the user.

Programming for Web sites can be classified as basic or core programming, visual programming, and programming with database systems. Specific languages are used for specific purposes.

Server-side programming refers to creating code that executes on the servers which send out Web pages.

On the server side, programming results in Web server software that responds to requests sent by the (client-side) browser by sending out information. For example, on banking and financial services sites, the code responsible for granting the user access to a credit card statement is server-side code.

